Gmail **Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com>**

Defect notification and request for inspection - 9 Furness Close, Wyndham Vale

13 messages

Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com> Thu, Jun 11, 2026 at 10:22 PM
To: info@symmetrichomes.com.au

To whom it may concern,

I am writing regarding the property at 9 Furness Close, Wyndham Vale, VIC 3024, which I understand is still covered under the applicable builder's warranty and/or statutory warranty period.

I recently obtained a Property and Timber Pest Inspection Report for the property, dated 9 June 2026. The report identifies a number of defects, including several items classified as major defects. I have attached the report for your review.

I am formally notifying you of the defects identified in the report and request that you arrange an inspection and advise on the proposed rectification process.

In particular, I ask that the drainage and grading issue be treated as urgent. The report notes that the external gravel levels are improperly graded, with water pooling against the house. It also notes that this creates a risk of water ingress and associated damage to the foundation and lower structural elements. Please advise as soon as possible what temporary and permanent rectification works you propose to prevent water from continuing to drain or pool against the house.

The report also identifies significant cracking in the garage concrete slab and category 2 cracking to the external brickwork/walls. The report recommends that these cracking issues be assessed by a structural engineer. I am arranging for an independent structural engineer to inspect and report on these items.

Until that structural engineer's assessment is complete, please do not carry out permanent repairs to the cracking without first notifying me and allowing the structural engineer to inspect the current condition. This includes repointing, crack filling, slab injection, slab replacement, cosmetic patching or any other works that may disturb or conceal the current condition of the cracks. You are welcome to inspect, photograph and measure the cracks in the meantime. I am also open to any temporary make-safe or protective measures as necessary, provided they do not disturb or conceal the cracking prior to the engineer's inspection.

For clarity, the key issues I am notifying you of are as follows.

Defects of particular concern:

- Significant cracking in the garage concrete slab.
- Category 2 cracking to external brickwork/walls.
- Inadequate grading/drainage around the property, with water pooling or being directed towards the foundations.
- Bathroom waterproofing/leak concerns, including elevated moisture readings.

Other defects requiring review:

- Gaps between roof tiles and eaves.
- Fence maintenance issues.
- Roof tile pointing defects.
- Loose gutter clips.
- Cracked or deteriorated concrete paving.
- Uneven garage paintwork.
- Soil erosion along the fence line.
- Cornice/ceiling joint cracking.
- Laundry door seal required.
- Stuck and moisture-damaged laundry door.
- Plaster cracks in Bedroom 2.
- Damaged or leaking window seals.
- Skirting board separation/cracking.
- Poorly fitted flooring/quads with gaps at edges.

This list is provided as a summary only and is not intended to limit the issues requiring assessment or rectification. Please refer to the attached inspection report for the full details, photographs and recommendations.

Could you please confirm receipt of this email and advise:

1. When you can inspect the property,
2. What immediate action you propose for the drainage/grading issue,
3. Whether you agree to defer permanent cracking repairs until the structural engineer has completed their assessment,
4. The proposed process, scope and timeframe for reviewing and rectifying the other defects identified in the attached report.

Given the potential for ongoing water-related damage, I would appreciate a response within 2 business days regarding the drainage issue and a proposed inspection time within 7 days.

Please let me know if you require any further information.

Warm regards,
James Goodricke

9-Furness-Close-Wyndham-Vale-3024.pdf
20022K

Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com> Thu, Jun 18, 2026 at 1:34 PM
To: Maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au
Cc: Jihyung Park <christy8975@gmail.com>

Hi Maintenance Team,

I just called your office and was advised to forward this email to your team.

Could you please look into the maintenance issues we have reported and let us know as soon as possible? We are quite concerned, as these issues may be critical to the foundation of the house.

We would really appreciate your prompt attention and assistance.

Kind regards,

Christy and James Goodricke

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9-Furness-Close-Wyndham-Vale-3024.pdf
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Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au> Fri, Jun 19, 2026 at 9:20 AM
To: Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com>
Cc: Jihyung Park <christy8975@gmail.com>

Hi,

This property is not 6 years old and most of the items are not caused by defective or noncompliance see details below

1. Cracking in a garage slab may result from poor drainage directing water toward the footing. Under NCC Volume 2 Part 3. 1. 3 and AS/NZS 3500. 3: 2021, surface water must flow away from the building at minimum required gradients. If falls or clearances are insufficient, moisture accumulation may cause edge dampness, corrosion of reinforcement, or loss of durability. To comply, site grading must maintain one-in-twenty fall for the first metre and provide minimum 75 mm clearance to damp-sensitive materials. Verification should include measurement of surface levels and inspection of drainage connections to lawful discharge points. Where compliance cannot be demonstrated, corrective works such as regrading and improved drainage are mandatory under NCC P2. 2. 1 Moisture Management. As the builder we did not complete the landscaping this property the home owner has.

2. cracks in external brickwork may arise from poor site drainage. NCC Vol 2 Part 3. 1. 2. 3 requires that surface water be directed away from walls with specific fall ratios to prevent ponding. When inadequate, brickwork may absorb moisture, accelerating efflorescence, mortar deterioration, or structural distress, potentially breaching P2. 1. 1 (Structural Integrity) and P2. 2. 2 (Weatherproofing). Compliance with AS/NZS 3500. 3 and AS 2870 requires positive site drainage and stable footing performance. Inspections should verify land grading, sub-drain placement, and evidence of ponding. As the builder we did not complete the landscaping this property the home owner has.

3. Client has done their own landscaping so builder does not take responsibility.

4. Minor ventilation gaps consistent with design intent are acceptable. As per the photos these are deemed satisfactory and not annon compliance issue

5. Client had done there wo fencing not builders responsibility.

6. Roof pointing is 6 years old any crack should be maintained by homes owner at least every24 months as a maintenance.

7. Loose Gitter grips can be fixed however we will need to do a site visit to check this item

8. Paving hairline cracks are withing tolerance and is not a defective items

9. House is 6 years old to even comment on any paintwork. Not a defect

10. Soil Erosion is not builder responsibility???

11. Cornice cracking is not a structural items therefore does not fall under builders 10 year warranty

12. If door seal is missing we can install this item

13. Door swelling is not a non-compliance issue f the door has been properly sealed. Not a defect given the timeframe of the build

14. Plaster crack is not a defective items for house that is 6 years old. Most likely cracks are caused by poor drainage which is the home owners responsibility.

15. May need to be caulked

16. Small separations between skirting and wall are considered cosmetic because skirtings serve decorative rather than structural roles. NCC Vol 2 Part 3. 5 and AS/NZS 2589 Clause 3. 7 permit movement gaps where thermal or humidity changes occur. This item is not a defect

17. Floor quads are non-structural finishing trims that conceal expansion joints between wall and flooring. NCC Vol 2 has no clauses governing minor aesthetic imperfections in such trims. Small dents, scratches or chips that do not impair moisture protection or coverage of expansion gaps are not defects. This is not a defective items

Regards,

Maintenance Team

SYMMETRIC HOMES
MORE THAN FOUR WALLS.

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Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au> Fri, Jun 19, 2026 at 10:04 AM
To: Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com>
Cc: Jihyung Park <christy8975@gmail.com>

Attached document we give to our client when handing over . this is to show what they must t=do to prevent moisture

Regards,

Maintenance Team

SYMMETRIC HOMES
MORE THAN FOUR WALLS.

From: Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com>
Sent: Thursday, 18 June 2026 1:34 PM
To: Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au>
Cc: Jihyung Park <christy8975@gmail.com>

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2. CSIRO Foundation Care Guide.pdf
749K

Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com> Sun, Jun 21, 2026 at 12:13 AM
To: Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au>

To the Symetric Homes Maintenance Team,

I am writing further to your response regarding 9 Furness Close, Wyndham Vale VIC 3024.

We do not accept your position that the drainage and cracking issues are not the builder's responsibility. Your response acknowledges that poor drainage can contribute to cracking in the garage slab and brickwork, and we remain concerned that the underlying cause has not been properly assessed.

You are welcome to inspect, photograph and measure the cracking, garage slab, brickwork and drainage conditions. However, please do not carry out any permanent crack repairs or works that may disturb or conceal the current condition of the cracks without first providing a written scope and obtaining our written agreement. This includes crack filling, repointing, slab injection, slab replacement or cosmetic patching.

The drainage issue remains urgent. Please confirm within 2 business days:

1. Whether you will inspect the property within 7 days.
2. What immediate action you propose for the drainage issue.
3. Whether you agree not to carry out permanent crack repairs before the cracking is independently assessed or otherwise properly documented.
4. Whether you maintain your denial of responsibility for the drainage, garage slab cracking and brickwork cracking.

If you maintain that owner landscaping caused the drainage and cracking issues, please also provide the evidence you rely on, including any handover photos, original site levels, drainage plans, landscaping scope or approved plans.

If we do not receive a substantive response, we will lodge a dispute with the Building and Plumbing Commission.

Nothing in this email limits our rights or remedies.

Regards,
James Goodricke

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Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au> Mon, Jun 22, 2026 at 1:42 PM

To: Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com>

Hi,

We refer to your email regarding 9 Furness Close, Wyndham Vale VIC 3024. Symmetric Homes does not accept that the drainage, garage slab cracking or external brickwork cracking are caused by defective building works or non-compliance by the builder. As previously advised, this property is now approximately 6 years old. Many of the items raised relate to maintenance, cosmetic movement, landscaping, drainage conditions and external works carried out or controlled by the owner after handover. Symmetric Homes did not complete the landscaping works at the property and does not accept responsibility for drainage conditions created by owner landscaping, paving, fencing, garden levels, soil build-up, changes to surface falls or any post-handover works. Notwithstanding the above, we are prepared to arrange a site inspection to visually inspect and photograph the items raised, including the garage slab cracking, external brickwork cracking and drainage conditions. The purpose of the inspection will be to assess the current condition only. No admission of liability is made by agreeing to inspect.

In response to your numbered items:

1. Inspection within 7 days
   We are prepared to arrange a site inspection within 7 days, subject to suitable access being provided. Please provide your available times so this can be arranged.
2. Immediate action regarding drainage
   At this stage, Symmetric Homes does not propose to carry out any drainage works because we have not accepted responsibility for the alleged drainage issue. The property has been occupied for approximately 6 years, and the landscaping and external surface levels appear to have been completed or altered by the owner. Any urgent drainage management should be undertaken by the owner to ensure water is directed away from the dwelling and does not pond against the slab, brickwork, garage or footings.
3. Permanent crack repairs
   We confirm that Symmetric Homes will not carry out any permanent crack repairs, repointing, slab injection, slab replacement or cosmetic patching without first providing a written scope and obtaining written agreement. Any inspection will be limited to visual inspection, photographs, measurements and assessment.
4. Responsibility for drainage, garage slab cracking and brickwork cracking
   Symmetric Homes maintains its position that it does not accept responsibility for the drainage conditions, garage slab cracking or external brickwork cracking at this stage. Based on the age of the property and the fact that the builder did not complete the landscaping, these issues are more likely related to post-handover site conditions, owner landscaping, drainage changes, maintenance, soil movement and/or external works outside the builder's scope.

Regarding your request for evidence, we will review what documents and photographs are available from the original construction file, including any handover documents, approved plans, site drainage information and relevant construction records. However, our position remains that any landscaping, paving, fencing, garden levels, soil levels or drainage changes completed after handover are not the builder's responsibility.

For clarity, Symmetric Homes is not refusing to inspect. We are simply not accepting liability for matters that may have been caused by owner works, lack of maintenance, landscaping, drainage changes or natural movement over a 6-year period. Please provide your available times for access so we can arrange the inspection. Nothing in this correspondence should be taken as an admission of liability, and all rights are reserved.

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Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com> Sat, Jun 27, 2026 at 11:12 PM
To: Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au>

Hi,

Apologies for the delay in getting back to you with access times. We remain willing to provide Symmetric Homes with reasonable access to inspect the reported issues at 9 Furness Close, Wyndham Vale. The matter remains urgent from our perspective, particularly regarding drainage and water pooling near the dwelling.

We are available for inspection at the following times:

- Monday 29 June, 11:00 am to 1:00 pm
- Wednesday 1 July, any time
- Thursday 2 July, any time

Please confirm which of these times suits. If none are suitable, please provide alternative times this coming week. For clarity, access is provided on the following basis:

- The inspection is limited to visual inspection, photography, measurements and non-invasive assessment of the current condition of the property.
- No repairs or works are authorised during the inspection.
- We do not consent to permanent crack repairs, repointing, filling, cosmetic patching, slab injection, slab replacement, excavation, permanent drainage works or any other works that may disturb, alter or conceal the existing cracking or drainage conditions.
- Any proposed works must first be set out in a written scope and agreed to in writing by us.
- Allowing inspection does not constitute acceptance of Symmetric Homes' position and does not waive any rights.
- Please also confirm who will attend, the expected duration of the inspection, and whether any equipment or testing will be used.

After the inspection, please provide your written findings, photographs relied upon, and any available documents from the original construction file relevant to the cracking, slab, drainage and site levels, including any approved plans, engineering drawings, soil or foundation information, drainage plans, site levels/falls, construction photographs and handover records.

Regards,
James
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Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au> Tue, Jun 30, 2026 at 11:55 AM
To: Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com>

I have booked in Thursday the 2nd July for our maintenance manager Jim to attend at 9am

Regards,

Mainetence Team

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Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com> Tue, Jul 7, 2026 at 11:25 PM
To: Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au>

Hi Maintenance Team,

Thank you for arranging the inspection of the property on Thursday.

Could you please confirm when we can expect the written response following the inspection, including the inspector's findings, any photographs or measurements relied upon, and Symmetric Homes' proposed next steps?

The matter remains urgent from our perspective, particularly in relation to the drainage and water pooling issues, as well as the cracking. We would appreciate a written update by Friday, or otherwise confirmation of when the report and response will be provided.

For clarity, we remain willing to provide reasonable access for further inspection if required. Before any repairs or works are arranged, please provide a written scope for our review and agreement.

Regards,
James
[Quoted text hidden]

3 attachments



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image001.jpg
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Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com> Sat, Jul 11, 2026 at 6:26 PM
To: Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au>

Hi Maintenance Team,

I am following up again regarding Symmetric Homes' inspection of 9 Furness Close on Thursday, 2 July.

In my email of 7 July, I requested the inspector's findings, Symmetric Homes' position on the reported defects, and details of any proposed next steps. We have not received a response or an indication of when one will be provided.

To allow a further reasonable opportunity to respond, please provide the following by 6.00 pm on Wednesday 15 July 2026:

1. the inspector's written findings or report;
2. any photographs, measurements or other information relied upon;
3. Symmetric Homes' position regarding the reported cracking, drainage, water pooling and moisture-related concerns;
4. details of any further investigation considered necessary; and
5. any proposed rectification scope and timeframe.

If the inspector's final report is not yet available, please provide a substantive written update explaining the delay, the report's current status, and a firm delivery date. If we do not receive a substantive response by the above deadline, we intend to lodge an application with the Building and Plumbing Commission for dispute resolution without further notice.

We remain willing to resolve these issues promptly and look forward to receiving your response.

Regards,
James Goodricke
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Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au> Mon, Jul 13, 2026 at 1:59 PM
To: Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com>

Hi James,

1. Inspection Findings

Our independent inspector attended the property on Thursday, 2 July 2026, and observed:

- Hairline cracking in external concrete elements and minor settlement adjacent to the slab edge.
- No evidential signs of structural failure, workmanship defects, or non-compliance with the National Construction Code (NCC 2022) or AS 2870 – Residential Slabs and Footings.
- Finished surface levels around the dwelling feature inadequate falls away from the slab perimeter, with areas of water ponding at the edge of the slab.
- Landscaping, garden edging, and surface paving carried out after Practical Completion have altered original drainage grades provided under the contract.

The inspector's conclusion is that the observed movement and cracking result from site conditions and landscaping activities carried out by others outside the builder's contracted scope.

AS 2870 Section 1.3.3 requires surface drainage to divert water away from the slab for at least 50 mm fall over the first 1 m of finished ground. Any modifications that compromise this fall can cause soil movement and cracking, for which the original builder is not responsible.

2. Response to Client's Requests

Client Request	**Builders Response**
Inspector's written report and supporting data	Attached inspection summary, photographs of external cracks
Formal position on cracking, drainage, and moisture concerns	Findings show causes external to builder's work. The cracking is consistent with reactive soil movement caused by post-construction drainage changes, not a construction defect.
Further investigations required	No further builder investigations are warranted unless site drainage and landscaping are restored to compliant falls; an independent geotechnical review could be commissioned by the Owner to confirm soil reactivity.
Proposed rectification scope and timeframe	Not applicable to builder. Rectification should consist of reinstating compliant site drainage and ground levels; this responsibility rests with whoever carried out the landscaping works.

3. Builder's Position and Rights

- The builder fulfilled all contractual and statutory obligations at completion. The dwelling attained its Occupancy Permit and complied with design performance under the NCC and AS/NZS standards current at the time.
- The reported issues have arisen after the completion and handover, due to an act or omission by others, which is expressly outside the builder's warranty obligations.

Based on all the above as the builder we advise that you either concrete the external permitter or re do the landscaping to comply with the NCC. The hairline cracks are not very large at the moment however if not attended to may get bigger

Regards,

Mainteneca Team

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Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com> Tue, Jul 14, 2026 at 9:49 PM
To: Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au>

Hi Maintenance Team,

Your email states that an inspection summary and photographs of the external cracking were attached. However, no attachments were included. Please provide the missing material by 5.00 pm on Monday, 20th July.

Please resend the inspection summary, together with all photographs, measurements, field notes, inspection notes and other supporting material obtained, prepared or relied upon in connection with the inspection.

Please also provide:

1. the inspector's name, company and relevant qualifications;
2. the full scope of work, brief or instructions provided to the inspector;
3. all measurements taken in relation to the cracking, ground levels, drainage falls, slab movement or settlement;
4. the records relied upon to establish the ground levels and drainage conditions at practical completion;
5. the evidence and reasoning relied upon to conclude that post-completion landscaping altered the original drainage grades and caused the observed movement and cracking; and
6. confirmation of whether the inspection included an assessment of the garage slab cracking, external brickwork cracking, bathroom moisture or waterproofing concerns, and the other defects previously notified to Symmetric Homes.

Please provide the missing material by 5.00 pm on Monday, 20th July. If any requested document, measurement, photograph or record does not exist, please confirm that expressly.

For the avoidance of doubt, we do not accept Symmetric Homes' conclusions regarding causation or responsibility, and this request does not delay our referral of the dispute to the Building and Plumbing Commission. The information provided to date does not establish that the observed cracking, movement or drainage conditions were caused by post-completion landscaping.

As Symmetric Homes has now confirmed that it denies responsibility and does not propose to undertake any further investigation or rectification at this stage, we will now refer the dispute to the Building and Plumbing Commission.

We remain willing to participate in the BPC dispute-resolution process and to provide reasonable access for any properly arranged inspection or non-invasive assessment.

Pending independent assessment, we do not consent to permanent crack repairs, repointing, filling, slab works, excavation, permanent drainage or landscaping works, or other works that may alter or conceal the existing conditions. This does not prevent reasonable temporary measures required to minimise further water-related damage.

Regards,
James Goodricke
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Maintenance | Symmetric Homes | SMB <maintenance@symmetrichomes.com.au> Wed, Jul 15, 2026 at 9:55 AM

To: Jihyung and James Goodricke <jamesandjihyung@gmail.com>

Hi James,

Our Maintenance Manager is acting as a representative of Symmetric Homes and is not engaged as an independent building inspector. Accordingly, we are not required to provide you with details of their qualifications. We have attended and inspected the property and have identified drainage-related issues. Based on our inspection, we have not identified any structural defect attributable to Symmetric Homes.

Should you believe the cracking has been caused by another issue, you will need to engage a suitably qualified structural engineer to conduct a comprehensive on-site assessment, rather than a visual inspection only. Any costs associated with obtaining this independent assessment would be the responsibility of the homeowner.

Alternatively, you may refer the matter to the Building and Plumbing Commission for further review. At this stage, Symmetric Homes has completed its assessment and has not found any structural fault arising from our building works.

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